United Nations Office on Drugs and Crime

AIRCOP CONTAINER CONTROL PROGRAMME

World Customs Organization
Organisation mondiale des douanes

THE WEEKLY NEWSLETTER

SEIZURE WATCH

WEEK
44
25 Oct – 31 Oct 2026

1,953 seizure reports from 89 countries, 32% more than the week before. 119 were rated high risk. Cannabis (507) and cocaine (403) led the reports.

1,953	119	477 t	62
SEIZURE REPORTS	HIGH RISK	REPORTED WEIGHT	CONTAINER CASES
▲ 32% vs prior week	▲ 70% vs prior week	▲ 4% vs prior week	

TOP STORIES



TOP STORY

ELEPHANT IVORY · THAILAND

Over 3 tonnes of elephant tusks, ivory seized at Laem Chabang port

Elephant ivory, 3,000 kg; seized in Laem Chabang, Thailand; route Zambia to Thailand; hidden in container structure / false compartment.

Photo and report: Bangkok Post

READ THE REPORT →



NSA SRI LANKA

US–South Asia cooperation: SL steps up fight against transnational drug trade

NSA, 17,000 kg; seized in Colombo, Sri Lanka; hidden in legitimate cargo (industrial/ goods).

Photo and report: The Morning



COCAINE UNITED KINGDOM

Gang caught smuggling £450m of cocaine in blocks of cheese after 4.5 tonnes of Class A drug uncovered by cops

Cocaine, 4,500 kg; seized in Leeds, United Kingdom; hidden in legitimate cargo (food/ produce).

Photo and report: Chronicle Live



METHAMPHETAMINE UNITED STATES

National First Responders Day: Kern County Sheriff's Office KC-HIDTA: Drug task force dismantles multiple meth conversion labs in months-long operations

Methamphetamine, 971 kg; seized in San Bernardino, United States; hidden in legitimate cargo (food/produce).

Photo and report: Bakersfield.com

RISK WATCH: HIGHEST-RISK EVENTS

85	26 Oct	**Elephant ivory 3.0 t**	Laem Chabang, Thailand · Zambia → Thailand
80	31 Oct	**NSA 17.0 t**	Colombo, Sri Lanka
80	26 Oct	**Cigarettes 440 kg**	Manchester, United Kingdom
75	30 Oct	**Cocaine 4.5 t**	Leeds, United Kingdom
75	29 Oct	**Methamphetamine 500 kg**	Tennessee, United States
75	28 Oct	**Methamphetamine 971 kg**	San Bernardino, United States

ALSO MAKING NEWS

- Nearly Five Million Illegal Cigarettes Seized at Manchester Airport
- Thailand seizes over 3.1 tonnes of ivory hidden in timber from Zambia

- Police strike against organized crime: 2.5 tons of hashish and 600 kilos of cocaine seized and eight criminals arrested
- Over 800 kg seized: Polish police help bust one of Baltic states’ largest drug labs
- Offshore chase: 568 kilos of cocaine seized and three Dominicans captured in a coordinated operation between Colombia, the Dominican Republic and the US.
- 24 Charged in Massive Tennessee Cartel Drug Seizure
- Doc caught with luggage full of ecstasy, psychedelic chocolates, marijuana edibles: police

THE WEEK IN NUMBERS

Reports by risk band — High 119 — Medium 713 — Low 1,121



REPORTS PER DAY

Sun 25	198
Mon 26	257
Tue 27	265
Wed 28	355
Thu 29	292
Fri 30	328
Sat 31	258

MOST REPORTED DRUGS AND GOODS

Cannabis	507
Cocaine	403
NSA	186
Heroin/Opium	168
Methamphetamine	121
Ammunition	121
Firearms	112
Unspecified	102

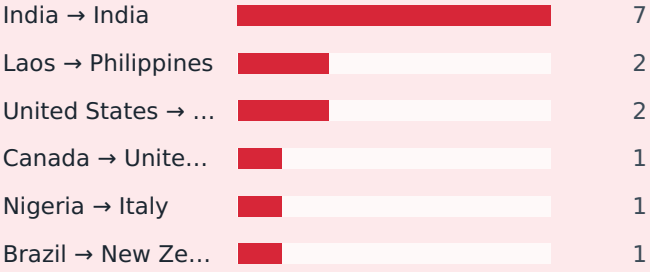
WHAT WAS SEIZED

Drug	1,487
Arms and ammu…	247
Tobacco	85
Cultural heritage	62
CITES protected …	28
Hazardous chem…	19

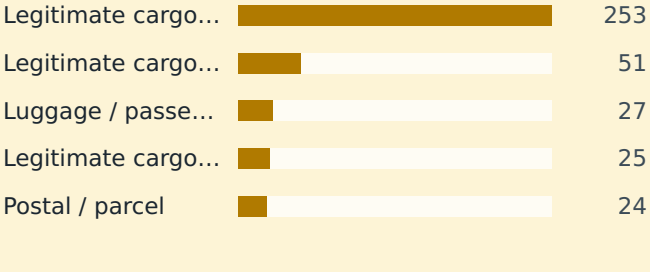
WHERE SEIZURES WERE MADE

India	327
Brazil	300
United States	207
Turkey	164
Mexico	89
Egypt	67
Canada	57
United Kingdom	35

BUSIEST ROUTES



HOW IT WAS HIDDEN



These are leads from open news sources, not confirmed facts. Verify before acting. Counts reflect what the tool found in the news it searches; a quiet country may mean no news or no coverage. Photos belong to the cited outlets and link back to their articles. Data runs to 2026-11-01.